TECHNOLOGY OWNERSHIP

Technology Ownership Toolkit

Nine practical checklists and templates to find, record and secure the technology your business depends on.

What is the Toolkit?

A short pack of nine one-page tools. Each one is a checklist to work through and a template to fill in. Together they help you find out what technology your business owns, record who controls it, and close the gaps.

Why use it?

Many businesses only learn who really controls their website or systems when something goes wrong: a provider leaves, a renewal lapses or a backup fails. Writing it down now turns those surprises into a plan.

Who is it for?

Business owners, founders and operations leads who rely on a website, app or system that someone else built or runs for them. No technical background is needed.

Version 1.0

How to use this toolkit

1. Start with Part 1 and work through the parts in order.
2. Spend about 20 minutes on each tool. Tick each item you can confirm, and fill in the template as you go.
3. Treat any item you cannot confirm as a gap, and give it an owner and a date.
4. Never write passwords in the templates. Record where things are kept, not the secrets themselves.
5. Review the whole toolkit every six months, or after a change of provider or developer.

What is inside

Part 1: Know what you own

Find out what you have and who controls it.

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Part 2: Stay in control of access and providers

Make sure no one person or supplier can lock you out.

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Part 3: Keep running and recover

Be ready for the day something fails or expires.

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PART 1 OF 3: Know what you own

Domain and DNS checklist

Make sure your business, not a provider, controls your domain name.

Checklist

- ☐ Find out which registrar holds each domain you use.
- ☐ Confirm the registrant and account owner are your business, using an email address you control.
- ☐ Check that auto-renew is on and the payment card is current.
- ☐ Turn on the registrar lock and two-factor sign-in.
- ☐ Record where your DNS records are managed.
- ☐ Save a copy of your current DNS records.

Template: Domain register

One entry per row. Record where things are kept, never passwords.

Domain	Registrar	Account email	Renewal date	Auto-renew	DNS managed at

Done when

You can name the registrar, the account owner and the renewal date for every domain.

Hosting and cloud checklist

Know where your application runs and who can administer it.

Checklist

- ☐ List every hosting, cloud and platform account your site or app uses.
- ☐ Confirm each account is registered to your business, not to a personal or provider email.
- ☐ Make sure at least two trusted people have administrator access.
- ☐ Check who receives the billing emails and who pays.
- ☐ Note the plan and region of each service.
- ☐ Turn on two-factor sign-in for every administrator.

Template: Hosting accounts

One entry per row. Record where things are kept, never passwords.

Service	Used for	Account owner	Administrators	Billing contact	Monthly cost

Done when

Every account is held by your business and has at least two administrators.

Source code checklist

Keep your application's code in a repository you own.

Checklist

- ☐ Find out where the code lives (the repository host and the organisation name).
- ☐ Confirm the repository belongs to your organisation account, not a developer's personal one.
- ☐ Check that you have owner-level access and know who else has it.
- ☐ Make sure the main branch is protected and changes are reviewed.
- ☐ Keep a copy of the code outside your provider's control, such as a mirror or archive.
- ☐ Confirm you hold the licence or a written assignment for the code.

Template: Code repositories

One entry per row. Record where things are kept, never passwords.

Repository	Host	Owner account	Who has access	Latest copy	Licence

Done when

You own the repository and hold a recent copy that you can open yourself.

Critical accounts register

Know every account your business depends on and who can get in.

Checklist

- ☐ List your email, analytics, payment, marketing, domain and hosting accounts.
- ☐ Record the owner and at least one backup administrator for each.
- ☐ Turn on two-factor sign-in for every critical account.
- ☐ Keep recovery codes in a shared, secured place, never in this register.
- ☐ Remove access for people and tools that no longer need it.
- ☐ Review the list every quarter.

Template: Critical accounts

One entry per row. Record where things are kept, never passwords.

Account	Used for	Owner	Backup administrator	Two-factor on	Last reviewed

Done when

No critical account depends on a single person or an unknown login.

Handover pack template

Make sure another qualified developer could pick up your setup.

Checklist

- ☐ Draw a one-page diagram of the main parts and how they connect.
- ☐ Write down how to build, run and deploy the application.
- ☐ List the environments (live and test) and their addresses.
- ☐ Record where configuration and secrets are kept, but not the secrets themselves.
- ☐ List the third-party services you use and what each one does.
- ☐ Name who to contact for each part of the system.

Template: Handover details

One entry per row. Record where things are kept, never passwords.

Area	Where it is documented	Owner	Last updated

Done when

A new developer could set the project up using only your handover pack.

Provider exit plan

Be able to change provider without losing data, code or time.

Checklist

- ☐ Check each contract for notice periods and exit terms.
- ☐ Confirm you can export your data, and in what format.
- ☐ Confirm you can transfer your domain and DNS without the provider's help.
- ☐ List everything that must move: code, data, files, email and certificates.
- ☐ Agree the order of the move and a safe switch-over date.
- ☐ Ask your current provider for a written handover commitment.

Template: Exit plan

One entry per row. Record where things are kept, never passwords.

Provider	Service	Notice period	What can be exported	Who does the move

Done when

You know what it would take to move each service, and how long it would take.

Backup and recovery checklist

Know your data is backed up and that you can restore it.

Checklist

- [ ] List the data and systems that must never be lost.
- [ ] Check how often each one is backed up and where the copies are kept.
- [ ] Make sure at least one copy is stored away from the live system.
- [ ] Run a test restore and note how long it took.
- [ ] Write down who can restore, and the steps they follow.
- [ ] Repeat the restore test at least twice a year.

Template: Backups

One entry per row. Record where things are kept, never passwords.

System	What is backed up	How often	Stored where	Last restore test	Owner

Done when

You have a recent, successful restore test for every critical system.

Renewals and costs calendar

Never lose a service to a missed renewal, and know what you pay.

Checklist

- ☐ List your domains, hosting, subscriptions, certificates and licences.
- ☐ Record the renewal date, cost and payment method for each.
- ☐ Set reminders for 60 and 14 days before each renewal.
- ☐ Make sure the billing email goes to an inbox someone monitors.
- ☐ Cancel anything you no longer use.
- ☐ Review the total yearly cost once a year.

Template: Renewals

One entry per row. Record where things are kept, never passwords.

Item	Provider	Renewal date	Cost	Paid by	Reminder set

Done when

Every renewal has an owner, a date and a reminder.

PART 3 OF 3: Keep running and recover

Maintenance and incident plan

Know who does what when something needs updating or goes wrong.

Checklist

- ☐ Decide who applies updates and security patches, and how often.
- ☐ Write down who to call first when the site or app is down.
- ☐ Agree how quickly each kind of problem should be handled.
- ☐ Keep a short contact list: provider, developer and hosting support.
- ☐ Note how you will tell customers when there is a problem.
- ☐ After any incident, write down what happened and what will change.

Template: Contacts and responsibilities

One entry per row. Record where things are kept, never passwords.

Role	Name	How to reach them	Responsible for

Done when

Anyone on your team can follow the plan the next time something fails.